

# Frost and ice

In winter, the days are short and the Sun hangs low in the sky, so we barely feel its warming rays. On clear nights, there is no blanket of clouds to keep in even this warmth. In some countries, it gets so cold that moisture in the air freezes, covering the ground with sparkling frost.

## Pretty cold!

If you live in a country where it gets very cold, you may see lovely patterns of fern frost on your windows. This is made when tiny water drops on the glass turn into ice. As more moisture freezes on top of these icy drops, feathery fingers of frost begin to grow.



*When moisture in the air freezes, it becomes frost.*

## Frosty nights

On cold nights, plants may get so cold that moisture in the air freezes onto them instantly, instead of forming liquid dew. This is called hoar frost.

